

What It Means

It does not matter what it means, poor heart,
The dear Lord knows, to bear it is your part,
Nor think some strange thing happens unto you
Which He would not allow so, if He knew.

He does not know. In His all- wise Fatherhood
He knows it and allows it for your good.
He is not hard, you do not think He is
When in the night you find your hand in His.

When it was light you sought to walk alone
And thought the strength He gave you all your own;
You did not ask what that last blessing meant- -
Just smiled and took it, satisfied, content.

You thought he knew
And planned the sweet surprise which came to you.
Then do you, tried one, take life's sweet and good
Yet cannot trust His all- wise Fatherhood?

But think it makes mistake whene'er it sends
Some hindrance which your eager haste offends?
You think it strange this trial, sift and keen,
And in your weakness ask, "What does it mean?"

I think the language of God's heart would read,
"I love My child, I note his slightest need,
I long to prosper him all his ways- -

To give him quiet nights and peaceful days.

“But if I do, he’ll lose himself from Me,
My outstretched hand he will not wait to see.
I’ll place a hindering wall before his feet,
There he will wait, and there we two shall meet.

“I do it not in wrath for broken laws,
Or willful disobedience, but because
I want him nearer and I cannot wait
For him to come, for he might wander late.

“My child will wonder, will not understand
Still half in doubt he’ll clasp My outstretched hand,
And when at last upon My heart he leans
He will have ceased to wonder what it means.”

Annie Johnson Flint